

Sunday, 6 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

26° 16°

BIRMINGHAM

Light drizzle

25° 14°

MANCHESTER

Drizzle

24° 14°

GLASGOW

Light drizzle

20° 15°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- Nigel Farage's Reform UK party is facing a donations row, with some insiders calling for a significant shift in its approach.**

Admirers within the party are pushing for a stronger, more organised operation as Reform UK sets its sights on gaining power. This comes amid scrutiny over the party's funding.

POLITICS · UK

- Reform UK has announced a new policy pledge, promising to increase the tax-free personal allowance to £15,000.**

The party claims this tax cut for individuals would be funded by making an ambitious £80 billion reduction in public spending. It's a key part of their economic vision.

POLITICS · UK

- Cleveland's Chief Constable says her force is being 'let down' by funding, despite being proud of her officers.**

Victoria Fuller told the BBC that police resources urgently need a rethink, speaking after a tragic crash on the A66 in Middlesbrough that killed seven people, including two officers.

CRIME · UK

- Transgender surgeries in Wales have been halted over concerns that patients may not have been properly assessed.**

The decision to pause procedures at the Welsh Gender Service has prompted a mixed reaction from patient groups and medical professionals. It raises questions about patient care standards.

HEALTH · UK

- The University of Cambridge has launched a review into the support provided to former professor Jason Arday before his death.**

The university stated the review will examine its 'decision-making and actions' in the period leading up to Professor Arday's passing. It aims to understand the circumstances better.

EDUCATION · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Jay-Z's long-awaited UK show in London saw surprise guests including Lauryn Hill, Wyclef Jean, and British rapper Giggs.**

The American superstar rolled back the years for over two hours at the first of his two capital shows. Fans were thrilled by the star-studded line-up.

ON AIR – What's the best surprise guest you've ever seen at a gig? Or who would you love to see join your favourite artist on stage?

MUSIC · THIS WEEKEND
- 2 Oasis fans have reportedly cracked the code for upcoming gigs at Celtic Park, thanks to a chip shop video.**

Internet sleuths spotted sets of numbers in posters featured in the video, which they believe reveal the map co-ordinates for Celtic's Parkhead stadium in Glasgow. It's sparked huge excitement.

ON AIR – Are you an Oasis fan, and would you go to extreme lengths to figure out a secret gig? Or do you prefer a straightforward ticket sale?

MUSIC · UPCOMING
- 3 Gavin and Stacey star Rob Brydon has expressed regret at turning down an interview with country music legend Dolly Parton.**

The comedian visited Dollywood during his TV series, 'Rob Brydon's Honky Tonk Road Trip,' but missed the chance to chat with the icon herself. A missed opportunity for sure!

ON AIR – If you could interview any celebrity, living or dead, who would it be and why?

TV · UPCOMING
- 4 A stunning anamorphic mural of Freddie Mercury has been unveiled at Wembley Park, delighting Queen fans.**

The artwork is designed so the image only fully resolves when viewed from a single marked spot about 65 feet away. It's a fantastic tribute to the legendary frontman.

ON AIR – What's your favourite piece of public art or a mural that's really caught your eye?

ART · THIS WEEKEND
- 5 Aardman Animations, the creative minds behind Wallace & Gromit, are celebrating 50 years with some fascinating secrets revealed.**

We're hearing stories like Gromit nearly being a cat, and the origins of silent Shaun the Sheep. It's a peek behind the curtain of their beloved creations.

ON AIR – What's your all-time favourite Aardman creation, and why does it stand out for you?

ANIMATION · ANNIVERSARY

On the schedule

1 Chelsea dropped points against Aston Villa for the first time in the Women's Super League, after a late equaliser.

Aston Villa scored against the run of play to disrupt Chelsea's strong start to the WSL campaign. It means the champions won't have it all their own way this season.

ON AIR – With Chelsea dropping points, do you think this WSL season will be more competitive at the top?
FOOTBALL · UK

2 Troy Parrott fired Real Betis to a surprising win over Real Madrid, with Kylian Mbappe missing a crucial penalty.

Parrott scored the only goal of the game, and Mbappe's injury-time miss sealed a 1-0 victory for Betis in La Liga. A huge upset in Spanish football!

ON AIR – What's the most dramatic penalty miss you've ever seen, or a moment where a star player just couldn't convert?
FOOTBALL · EUROPE

3 Luka Modric is planning to continue playing for Croatia past his 41st birthday, showing no signs of slowing down.

The veteran midfielder is not ready to retire from international football and hopes to feature in upcoming Nations League games, including against England. An incredible career continues!

ON AIR – Who's your favourite 'evergreen' sports star, someone who just keeps going against the odds?
FOOTBALL · EUROPE

4 Beau Greaves has made darts history by becoming the first woman to win a match on the European Tour.

Greaves beat Daryl Gurney at the Czech Open, marking a significant moment for women in professional darts. It's a fantastic achievement for the young player.

ON AIR – How important do you think it is to see more women breaking barriers in traditionally male-dominated sports?
DARTS · EUROPE

5 Five-time Tour de France champion Tadej Pogacar will miss the rest of the season after a crash at the Vuelta a Espana.

Pogacar suffered injuries, including a fracture in his neck, forcing him to withdraw from competition. It's a big blow for the cycling star.

ON AIR – When a top athlete is injured, how much do you think it impacts their sport's overall excitement for the rest of the season?
CYCLING · EUROPE

Quick hits

- 1 Gardeners are finding joy in cultivating 'microgreens' on their windowsills.**
These tiny, nutrient-packed plants like radish, rocket, and broccoli sprouts are easy to grow indoors, offering a fresh flavour boost to meals all year round. It's a lovely way to connect with nature, even in a small flat!
- 2 A delightful new trend sees people creating 'bespoke playlists' for their pets.**
Owners are curating calming tunes or upbeat melodies to suit their furry friends' moods, with some even reporting a noticeable difference in their pets' behaviour. Perhaps your dog prefers classical, or your cat a bit of jazz?
- 3 The humble 'charity shop' is becoming a treasure trove for unique home decor.**
Savvy shoppers are discovering vintage finds, quirky ornaments, and pre-loved furniture that add character and a personal touch to their living spaces. It's a sustainable way to refresh your home and support a good cause!
- 4 A fascinating study suggests that 'reading aloud' to yourself can boost memory.**
Researchers found that vocalising words helps to reinforce them in our minds, making information easier to recall. So, next time you're learning something new, don't be shy about having a little chat with yourself!
- 5 Many people are rediscovering the simple pleasure of 'writing postcards' whilst on holiday.**
In an age of instant messages, sending a handwritten postcard feels more personal and special, offering a lovely tangible memento for friends and family. It's a charming way to share your holiday adventures.
- 6 The art of 'pressed flower crafts' is seeing a beautiful revival.**
From creating intricate greeting cards to framing delicate botanical art, people are finding creative ways to preserve the beauty of flowers. It's a wonderful, gentle hobby that brings the garden indoors.
- 7 More people are embracing the joy of 'slow walking' to enhance well-being.**
Instead of rushing, deliberately taking a slower pace allows for greater observation of surroundings and a more mindful experience. It's a simple way to de-stress and appreciate the everyday.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of sparkling water will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: GIVING THE BOTTLE A LITTLE SHAKE AND LISTENING FOR THE FIZZ.

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, warm piece of toast, especially if it's got a new topping. What is it?

ANSWER: ARRANGING THE TOPPING INTO A PERFECTLY SYMMETRICAL PATTERN.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday object' in your home just seems to have a personality of its own, almost like a little character?

Whether it's a wonky lamp or a teapot with a chipped spout, what's that item in your house that you feel has a bit of quirky charm or a secret story?

- We all have those 'little personal traditions' we do on a Sunday, don't we, that just make the day feel right?

From a specific breakfast ritual to a favourite afternoon walk, what's your go-to Sunday tradition that helps you wind down or recharge for the week ahead?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that sloths can hold their breath longer than dolphins? A sloth can hold its breath for up to 40 minutes underwater, while a dolphin can only hold its breath for about 10 minutes.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The Northern Lights, or aurora borealis, can sometimes be heard as a faint whistling or crackling sound, which scientists believe is caused by the interaction of solar wind with the Earth's magnetic field.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The 'Great Fire of London' in 1666 actually started in a bakery on Pudding Lane.
- A 'flock of crows' is commonly referred to as a murder.
- The longest place name in the UK is Llanfairpwllgwyngyllgogerychwyrndrobwlilllantysiliogogoch, a village in Wales.
- The 'Post Office' in the UK was established in 1660 by King Charles II.
- Did you know that a baby rabbit is called a kit?
- The national flower of England is the rose.
- The world's first public railway, the Stockton and Darlington Railway, opened in the North East of England in 1825.
- Giraffes have the same number of neck vertebrae as humans, which is seven.

On this day

Day 249 of the year, 116 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast days: Begga; Christian feast days: Chagnoald; Christian feast days: Faustus, Abibus and Dionysius of Alexandria; Christian feast days: Gondulphus of Metz. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 2000 — David Kushner, American singer-songwriter
- 1974 — Justin Whalin, American actor
- 1942 — Mel McDaniel, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2011)
- 2001 — Freya Allan, English actress
- 1973 — Greg Rusedski, Canadian-English tennis player and sportscaster
- 1947 — Sylvester, American singer-songwriter (died 1988)
- 1980 — Kerry Katona, English singer and actress
- 1978 — Foxy Brown, American rapper

THE DAY TODAY

- 1976 — Cold War: Soviet Air Defence Forces pilot Viktor Belenko lands a Mikoyan-Gurevich MiG-25 jet fighter at Hakodate in Japan and requests political asylum in the United States; his request is granted.
- 2009 — The ro-ro ferry SuperFerry 9 sinks off the Zamboanga Peninsula in the Philippines with 971 persons aboard; all but ten are rescued.
- 1986 — In Istanbul, two terrorists from Abu Nidal's organization kill 22 and wound six congregants inside the Neve Shalom Synagogue during Shabbat services.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1988 — End of the last stage of the Anfal campaign of Ba'athist Iraq against its Kurdish population, which resulted in major destructions and major civilian losses.
- 1976 — Cold War: Soviet Air Defence Forces pilot Viktor Belenko lands a Mikoyan-Gurevich MiG-25 jet fighter at Hakodate in Japan and requests political asylum in the United States; his request is granted.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1983 — The Soviet Union admits to shooting down Korean Air Lines Flight 007, stating that its operatives did not know that it was a civilian aircraft when it reportedly violated Soviet airspace.

- 2018 — Supreme Court of India decriminalised all consensual sex among adults in private, making homosexuality legal on the Indian lands.
- 2022 — Russo-Ukrainian war: Ukraine begins its Kharkiv counteroffensive, surprising Russian forces and retaking over 3,000 square kilometers of land, recapturing the entire Kharkiv Oblast west of the Oskil River, within the next week.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 250 of the year, 115 days left in 2026. Today Air Force Day (Pakistan); Christian feast day: Anastasius the Fuller; Christian feast day: Clodoald; Christian feast day: Blessed Giovanni Battista Mazzucconi. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1956 — Diane Warren, American songwriter
- 1961 — LeRoi Moore, American saxophonist and songwriter (died 2008)
- 1987 — Danny North, English footballer
- 1987 — Sammy Moore, English footballer
- 1986 — Charlie Daniels, English footballer
- 1977 — Jon Macken, English-Irish footballer
- 1956 — Byron Stevenson, Welsh footballer (died 2007)
- 1973 — Shannon Elizabeth, American model and actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1977 — The Torrijos–Carter Treaties between Panama and the United States on the status of the Panama Canal are signed. The United States agrees to transfer control of the canal to Panama at the end of the 20th century.
- 1953 — Nikita Khrushchev is elected first secretary of the Communist Party of the Soviet Union.
- 1979 — The Chrysler Corporation asks the United States government for US\$1.5 billion to avoid bankruptcy.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1997 — Maiden flight of the Lockheed Martin F-22 Raptor.
- 1978 — While walking across Waterloo Bridge in London, Bulgarian dissident Georgi Markov is assassinated by Bulgarian secret police agent Francesco Gullino by means of a ricin pellet fired from a specially designed umbrella.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar